Hackathon Project: Automating My Online Event Producer Script

Project: Online Event Producer Script Automation
Tools Used: AI prompting, O'Reilly Expert Intelligence, Visual Studio Code (VS Code), Google Apps Script, Google Sheets

Project Overview

For my Hackathon project, I wanted to explore how AI and automation could make my daily work as an Online Event Producer easier.

I regularly prepare facilitator scripts for O'Reilly Live Courses. These scripts include the course title, instructor information, recording details, and important housekeeping information for attendees.

I started by experimenting with different AI prompting techniques to see which approach would produce the most useful facilitator script. As I worked through the project, I realized I could take it further by automating some of the repetitive steps I complete before each event.

My goal was to save time, reduce manual copying and pasting, and improve accuracy.

Step 1: Testing Different AI Prompting Techniques

I tested three prompting approaches: zero-shot, one-shot, and decomposition.

Zero-Shot Prompting

For my first test, I gave the model instructions without providing an existing script as an example.

My prompt:

"Write a friendly and professional opening facilitator script for an O'Reilly Live Course called '[Course Name]' with instructor '[Instructor Name].' Include information about chat and Q&A, the recording, privacy, Regulated Status, the post-event survey, and that attendees will receive the recording within 24–48 hours. Introduce me as Joan, the session facilitator, and end by handing the session over to the instructor."

What I was testing:

Could the model produce a usable script from instructions alone?

The result was a reasonable first draft, but it still needed some reviewing and editing.

One-Shot Prompting

For my second test, I provided my existing facilitator script as an example and asked the model to create a version for a different course and instructor.

This worked better because the model had an example of the tone, structure, and information I needed.

The result sounded more natural and was closer to something I could actually use during a live event.

Supporting example: AI Transformation Group Chat

Decomposition Prompting

For my third test, I broke the facilitator script into smaller requirements:

- Welcome and introduction
- Chat and Q&A instructions
- Recording and privacy information
- Regulated Status
- Recording availability
- Post-event survey
- Instructor handoff

This approach gave me the most control and made it easier to check that all the required information was included.

However, it also took more time to write the prompt.

Step 2: Comparing My Results

After testing all three approaches, I found that one-shot prompting worked best for my needs.

Zero-shot was the quickest, and decomposition provided the most structure. But since I already have a standard facilitator script, providing that example gave me a good result without having to explain every detail from scratch.

My biggest takeaway was that AI works better for this task when I give it an example of what I actually need.

Step 3: Exploring Additional Tools

As I continued working on the project, I used the O'Reilly Expert Intelligence plugin and Visual Studio Code (VS Code) as part of my process.

I wanted to go beyond generating a script with AI and explore how I could automate the information that changes from course to course.

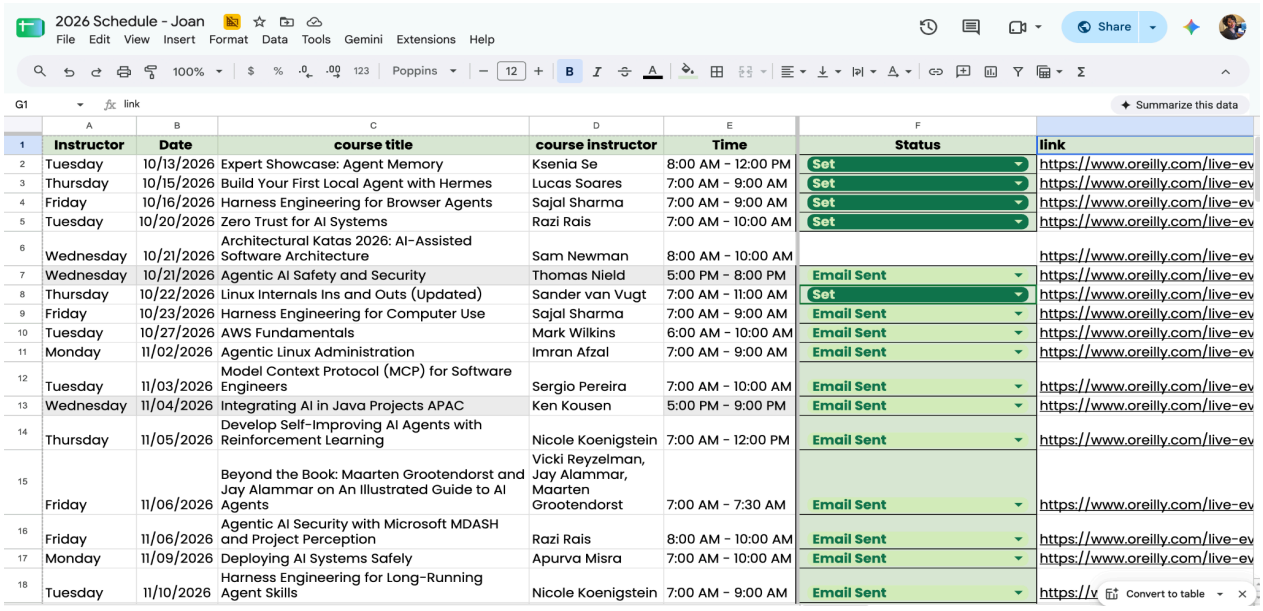
I already had a sanitized Google Sheet containing my monthly course schedule, including course titles, instructor names, start times, and recording links.

That gave me an idea: instead of manually copying this information into my facilitator script every day, could I automate it? I used VS Code as part of developing the code for this workflow, including handling the recording-link information.

Step 4: Building My Google Apps Script Automation

I built and tested a Google Apps Script that pulls the day's course title, instructor, and recording link from my sanitized Google Sheet.

The script uses that information to create a new Google Doc based on the group chat facilitator script I use daily. I also set up a daily trigger so the automation runs before the event. This cuts down on the amount of information I have to manually copy and paste and helps reduce mistakes, such as using the wrong instructor, course title, or link. Having fun with this!



	A	B	C	D	E	F	G
1	Instructor	Date	course title	course instructor	Time	Status	link
2	Tuesday	10/13/2026	Expert Showcase: Agent Memory	Ksenia Se	8:00 AM - 12:00 PM	Set	https://www.oreilly.com/live-ev
3	Thursday	10/15/2026	Build Your First Local Agent with Hermes	Lucas Soares	7:00 AM - 9:00 AM	Set	https://www.oreilly.com/live-ev
4	Friday	10/16/2026	Harness Engineering for Browser Agents	Sajal Sharma	7:00 AM - 9:00 AM	Set	https://www.oreilly.com/live-ev
5	Tuesday	10/20/2026	Zero Trust for AI Systems	Razi Rais	7:00 AM - 10:00 AM	Set	https://www.oreilly.com/live-ev
6	Wednesday	10/21/2026	Architectural Katas 2026: AI-Assisted Software Architecture	Sam Newman	8:00 AM - 10:00 AM		https://www.oreilly.com/live-ev
7	Wednesday	10/21/2026	Agentic AI Safety and Security	Thomas Nield	5:00 PM - 8:00 PM	Email Sent	https://www.oreilly.com/live-ev
8	Thursday	10/22/2026	Linux Internals Ins and Outs (Updated)	Sander van Vugt	7:00 AM - 11:00 AM	Set	https://www.oreilly.com/live-ev
9	Friday	10/23/2026	Harness Engineering for Computer Use	Sajal Sharma	7:00 AM - 9:00 AM	Email Sent	https://www.oreilly.com/live-ev
10	Tuesday	10/27/2026	AWS Fundamentals	Mark Wilkins	6:00 AM - 10:00 AM	Email Sent	https://www.oreilly.com/live-ev
11	Monday	11/02/2026	Agentic Linux Administration	Imran Afzal	7:00 AM - 9:00 AM	Email Sent	https://www.oreilly.com/live-ev
12	Tuesday	11/03/2026	Model Context Protocol (MCP) for Software Engineers	Sergio Pereira	7:00 AM - 10:00 AM	Email Sent	https://www.oreilly.com/live-ev
13	Wednesday	11/04/2026	Integrating AI in Java Projects APAC	Ken Kousen	5:00 PM - 9:00 PM	Email Sent	https://www.oreilly.com/live-ev
14	Thursday	11/05/2026	Develop Self-Improving AI Agents with Reinforcement Learning	Nicole Koenigstein	7:00 AM - 12:00 PM	Email Sent	https://www.oreilly.com/live-ev
15	Friday	11/06/2026	Beyond the Book: Maarten Grootendorst and Jay Alammar on An Illustrated Guide to AI Agents	Vicki Reyzelman, Jay Alammar, Maarten Grootendorst	7:00 AM - 7:30 AM	Email Sent	https://www.oreilly.com/live-ev
16	Friday	11/06/2026	Agentic AI Security with Microsoft MDASH and Project Perception	Razi Rais	8:00 AM - 10:00 AM	Email Sent	https://www.oreilly.com/live-ev
17	Monday	11/09/2026	Deploying AI Systems Safely	Apurva Misra	7:00 AM - 10:00 AM	Email Sent	https://www.oreilly.com/live-ev
18	Tuesday	11/10/2026	Harness Engineering for Long-Running Agent Skills	Nicole Koenigstein	7:00 AM - 9:00 AM	Email Sent	https://v

Step 5: How The Automation Works

One of the things I really wanted to automate was the recording link in my facilitator script. Since the recording link is actually the same as the course registration link, I used the O'Reilly Expert Intelligence plugin in ChatGPT to help generate the recording links and add them to column G of my personal course schedule in Google Sheets. The course titles were already listed in column C, so I was able to match the correct links to each course. This saved me time and gave me one place to keep all the information I needed for my daily events.

Once I had the links in my Google Sheet, I used Google Apps Script to automatically pull that information into my facilitator script.

Here's how it works:

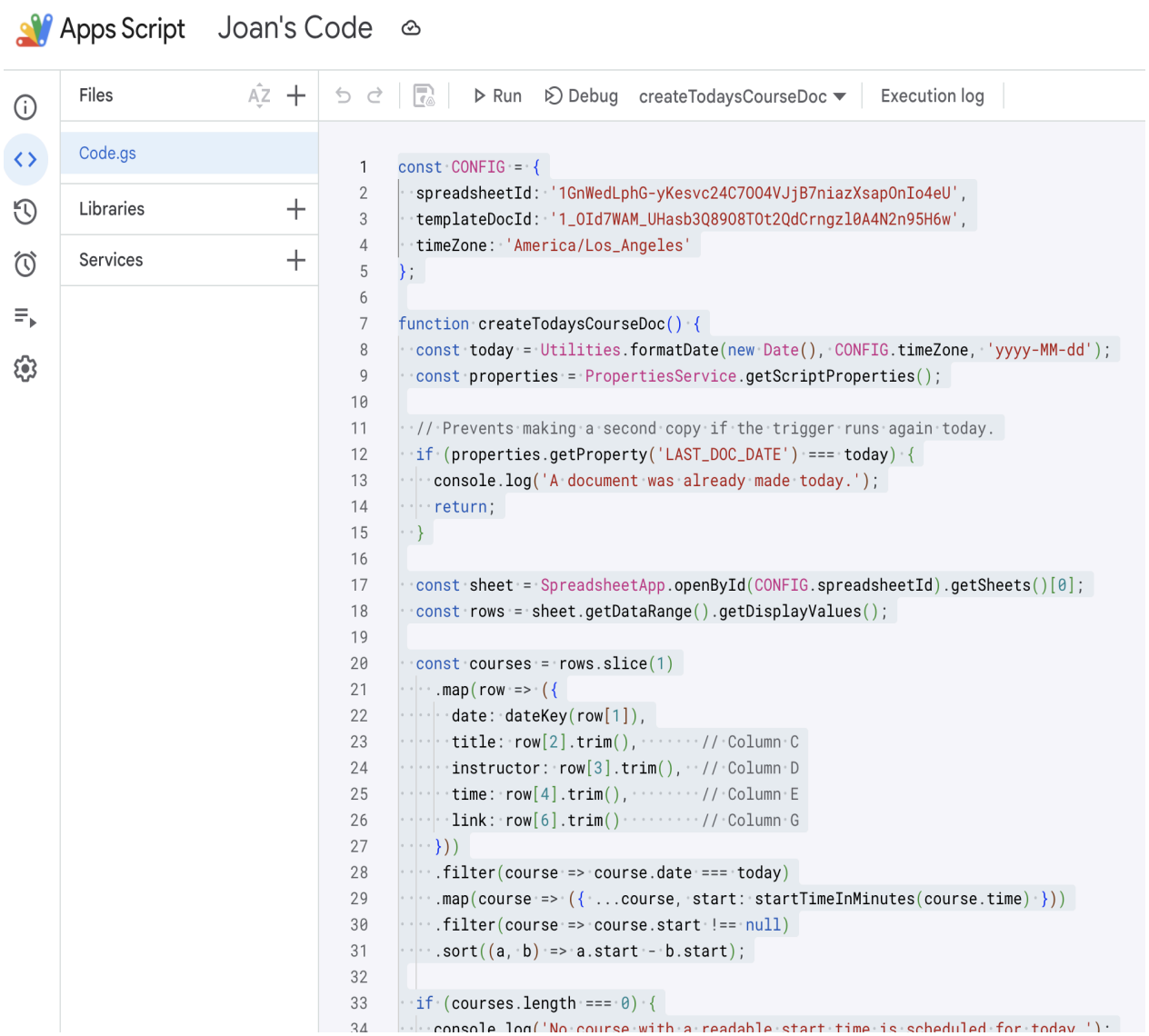
1. My Google Sheet contains the course titles in column C, instructor names in column D, and recording/registration links in column G.
2. My Google Apps Script retrieves the information for the scheduled course.
3. The script finds the placeholders for the course title, instructor, and `[link]` in my Google Doc template.
4. It replaces those placeholders with the correct information from my Google Sheet.

This means I no longer have to manually enter those details daily.

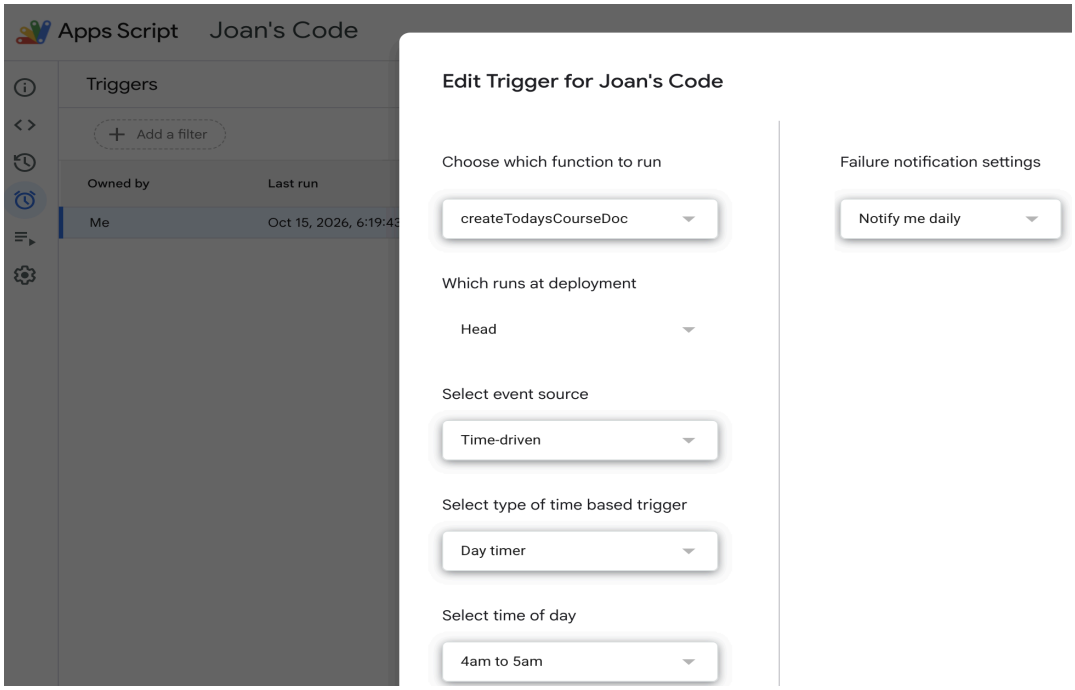
Step 6: Using AI in VS Code to Automate My Facilitator Script

I wanted to take my Hackathon project a step further by automating the repetitive work I do when preparing my daily facilitator script. Since I'm new to coding, I used the AI chat feature in VS Code to explain what I wanted to accomplish. I told it that I had a sanitized Google Sheet containing my course schedule and wanted to automatically pull the course title, instructor's name, and recording link into my Google Doc facilitator script. The AI in VS Code generated the JavaScript code, which I then copied into Google Apps Script.

From there, I connected the script to my Google Sheet and Google Doc template. The code uses placeholders for the course title, instructor, and recording link (`[link]`) and replaces them with the correct information from my schedule.



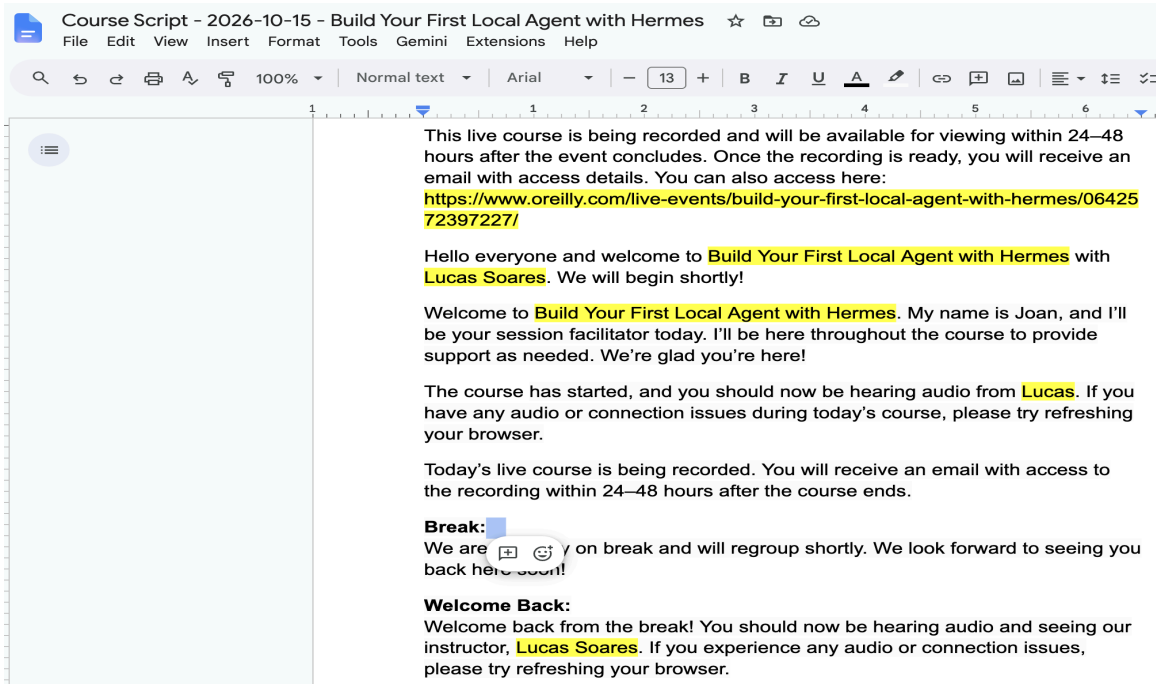
I also set up a daily time-based trigger in Google Apps Script so the automation runs before my events. The trigger is configured to run at approximately 4 AM Pacific Time. Each day, the script checks my schedule, selects the earliest scheduled course with a readable start time, and creates a new document using my facilitator script template.



The new document follows this naming convention: **Course Script - Date - Course Title**

This means my original template stays unchanged, and I have a new facilitator script with the correct course information ready for the day.

YAY! I automated my script. It saves me time, reduces manual copying and pasting, and helps prevent mistakes when preparing for my live events.



Step 7: What I Learned

This project helped me see how AI and automation can work together. AI was useful for experimenting with the language, tone, and structure of my facilitator script.

Google Apps Script was useful for automating repetitive tasks using information I already had in my schedule. I also gained experience using VS Code and working with JavaScript.

What started as a simple prompt engineering experiment turned into something I can use in my daily workflow.

Final Thoughts

Personal Review Criteria for AI-Assisted Work

AI drafts and I judge. That's one of my biggest takeaways from this Hackathon project. Even when AI and automation make my job easier, it's still important for me to review the results. My personal review criteria include accuracy, consistency, clear communication, and making sure the information is appropriate for a live event. For example, my Google Apps Script automatically pulls the course title, instructor's name, and recording link from my Google Sheet into a new facilitator script. Even though the automation is working, I still need to check that the correct information was pulled and that the script sounds natural and professional. This is where human-in-the-loop is important. AI and automation can handle the repetitive work, but I'm still responsible for making sure everything is correct before the event begins.

My quality bar is simple: Would I feel comfortable using this script during a live O'Reilly course without having to make last-minute corrections**?** If the answer is yes, then it meets my expectations. I think my teammates would have similar review criteria when it comes to accuracy, professionalism, and providing a good attendee experience. However, everyone's responsibilities are a little different, so their individual checks might vary. For me, the biggest takeaway is that AI and automation should support the work we do, not replace our judgment. I love that I've automated part of my daily preparation, but I also know that taking a few minutes to review the final result is still an important part of my job. AI drafts and I judge, and that balance is what makes this process work for me.

I was able to build and test an automation that helps prepare my daily facilitator script using information from my course schedule.

It saves manual preparation steps, helps improve accuracy, and gives me more time to focus on producing a smooth live event. I'm excited to keep learning and see what else I can automate.